

fn quantile_cnd

Aishwarya Ramasethu (@aramasethu), Yu-Ju Ku (@yuju1998), Jordan Awan, Michael Shoemate (@Shoeboxam)

May 9, 2026

This proof resides in “contrib” because it has not completed the vetting process.

Compute the quantile of a canonical noise distribution, as specified by a tradeoff function f .

1 Hoare Triple

Precondition

Compiler-verified

- Argument `uniform` of type `RBig`
- Argument `f`, a function from `RBig` to `RBig`
- Argument `c` of type `RBig`

Caller-verified

- Argument `uniform` is in $[0, 1]$
- Argument `f` is a symmetric nontrivial tradeoff function
- Argument `c` is the fixed point of `f`, where $f(c) = c$

Pseudocode

```
1 def quantile_cnd(  
2     uniform: RBig, f: Callable[[RBig], RBig], c: RBig  
3 ) -> RBig | None:  
4     if uniform.is_zero() or uniform == RBig(1):  
5         return None  
6  
7     if uniform < c:  
8         return quantile_cnd(RBig(1) - f(uniform), f, c) - RBig(1)  
9     elif uniform <= RBig(1) - c: # the linear function  
10         num = uniform - RBig(1, 2)  
11         den = RBig(1) - RBig(2) * c  
12         if den.is_zero():  
13             return  
14         return num / den  
15     else:  
16         return quantile_cnd(f(RBig(1) - uniform), f, c) + RBig(1)
```

Postcondition

Theorem 1.1. If `uniform` $\in (0, 1)$, the pseudocode evaluates the quantile function $F_f^{-1}(u)$ as defined in Proposition F.6 of Awan and Vadhan 2023. If `uniform` $\in \{0, 1\}$, the pseudocode returns `None`.

Proof. We start by defining $F_f(\cdot)$:

Definition 1.2 (Awan and Vadhan 2023, Definition 3.7). Let f be a symmetric nontrivial tradeoff function, and let $c \in [0, 1/2)$ be the unique fixed point of f : $f(c) = c$. We define $F_f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ as

$$F_f(x) = \begin{cases} f(1 - F_f(x + 1)) & x < -1/2 \\ c \cdot (1/2 - x) + (1 - c)(x + 1/2) & -1/2 \leq x \leq 1/2 \\ 1 - f(F_f(x - 1)) & x > 1/2. \end{cases} \quad (1)$$

The preconditions for `quantile_cnd` satisfy the preconditions for this definition. The quantile function $F_f^{-1}(u)$ is defined in the following lemma.

Proposition 1 (Awan and Vadhan 2023, Proposition F.6). The quantile function $F_f^{-1} : (0, 1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ for F_f can be expressed as

$$F_f^{-1}(u) = \begin{cases} F_f^{-1}(1 - f(u)) - 1 & u < c \\ \frac{u - 1/2}{1 - 2c} & c \leq u \leq 1 - c \\ F_f^{-1}(f(1 - u)) + 1 & u > 1 - c, \end{cases} \quad (2)$$

where c is the unique fixed point of f . Furthermore, for any $u \in (0, 1)$, the expression $Q_f(u)$ takes a finite number of recursive steps to evaluate. Thus, if $U \sim U(0, 1)$, then $F_f^{-1}(U) \sim F_f$.

`quantile_cnd` is the quantile function $F_f^{-1}(u)$, `f` is the tradeoff function f , `uniform` is u , and `c` is the fixed point of f , as guaranteed in the precondition.

If `uniform` $\in \{0, 1\}$, the pseudocode returns `None` immediately. This is consistent with Proposition 1, which defines F_f^{-1} only on $(0, 1)$, and avoids infinite recursion at the endpoints.

If `uniform` $\in (0, 1)$, the endpoint guard does not apply, and the pseudocode uses exact arithmetic to implement the three cases of Proposition 1 exactly. Therefore, on $(0, 1)$, `quantile_cnd` evaluates $F_f^{-1}(u)$, satisfying the postcondition. □

References

Awan, Jordan and Salil Vadhan (2023). “Canonical Noise Distributions and Private Hypothesis Tests”. In: *The Annals of Statistics* 51.2, pp. 547–572.